in the healthcare and financial services industries is a telling sign of the times, and a reminder of how much we all have to lose.

Centrally-Managed Endpoint Security

Prolific threats require a pervasive solution. To reclaim peace of mind and control of the network perimeter, each endpoint must be secured. Distributed endpoint security, centrally managed personal firewalls, and application control technology offer the best defence against attacks that threaten corporate productivity, data, and reputation. IDC notes, ". . .as 'always-on' Internet access grows (with digital subscriber line [DSL] and cable modems) and as more companies allow telecommuting, the need for distributed and personal firewalls will grow." Consequently, Peter Lindstrom of the Hurwitz Group stated, "The personal firewall may well become more significant in the long run than the corporate firewall." Personal firewalls and application control can also help secure endpoints behind the corporate firewall, by preventing internal hacking, unknown Trojans, and spyware from exposing sensitive data outside the corporation.

Similar to a corporate network, each individual PC—local and remote—must employ multiple approaches to security technology. Only a policy-based, application-oriented distributed firewall, on each and every enterprise PC, can provide the protection needed to stop thousands of new and unknown hacking combinations and techniques.

For true endpoint security, a distributed firewall must incorporate the following functions:

- Obscure PCs to prevent outside access from hackers
- Prevent applications from becoming hacker tools by allowing only authenticated and approved applications to access the Internet
- Secure e-mail attachments to prevent e-mail from being used as a transmission tool for viruses and malicious worms
- Block, alert and log intrusions
- Provide cooperative gateway protection to leverage the existing IS infrastructure and ensure that only endpoints with distributed firewalls and current security policy access the network